



Your Questions, Our Answers

All your computing niggles and nags are dealt with here!

An overheating power supply

Q Hi, this is Dhruv and I am a regular reader of your magazine. My configuration is an Intel Pentium 4 HT (3 GHz), a ASUS P5VDC MX, a Samsung 80 GB HDD, a Sony DVD writer, an ATX cabinet and a gigabyte of memory. My problem is that whenever I play GTA : San Andreas, my SMPS heats up and the game stops working. Please suggest a solution. Is this system configuration enough to run this game? Please help.

Dhruv Karnick

A If the game runs and you can play reasonably well on it without any major slow-downs, then the system should be good enough to run GTA: San Andreas but we highly recommend that you upgrade your system. An overhaul that includes putting an Intel or AMD dual core processor and a graphics card will do wonders for you. If you are a major gamer, then you would enjoy a system like that. If GTA : San Andreas is the only game that you want to play, then a graphic card upgrade will be just fine.

The problem of your power supply heating up is likely to be a spoilt fan at the back of the power supply. Check to see if its still running or is clogged with dirt. Do not open the power supply but get it fixed or replaced if it's under warranty.

Laptop shuts down randomly

Q I have an Acer laptop that's around six years old now. It keeps repeatedly shutting down when I use it. There is always a fan noise when an application starts some other times; it just shuts down on its own. What could be the reason? Please help me.

My laptop configuration is: Acer Travelmate 2501LC which uses an Intel Pentium 4 2.8 GHz, an ATI Mobility Radeon 9000 IGP, 256 MB DDR333 SDRAM, 40 GB Ultra ATA/100 HDD and a DVD/CD-RW Combo drive.

Vishwas Kamath

A Your laptop is really old and it's a good idea to get it serviced sometime. The fan you are talking about might be failing or it might be clogged with dust. It needs to be opened up and cleaned up. Also, get it looked at by your laptop manufacturer if possible.

Conflicting information BIOS and system monitoring software

I recently assembled a desktop PC with following configuration.

Processor : Intel Core 2 Duo E8400 (3.00 GHz)

Mother board : DG33TL

HDD : 250 GB

RAM : 2 GB DDR2 800 MHz

I want your opinion. The BIOS of the system say that system bus speed is 1333 MHz. The L2 cache is 6144 KB there is no mention of the L1 cache. The system monitoring software (Desktop utility version 3.0) supplied with the motherboard shows some other details.

System bus speed : 333 MHz

L1 cache : Data cache 32 KB, Code cache 32 KB per processor core

L2 cache : Not Supported

Why is the system monitoring software displaying wrong information about the system and how can I solve it? After two to three seconds of starting up the computer, the system switches on momentarily then goes off again. After that, it switches back on normally. Is this normal?

Sanjay Sinha

The delay in startup of the computer is normal on some motherboards. Try installing a different software such as CPU-Z to identify details about your processor. CPU-Z is free for download from www.cpubid.com. Look for any updates for the system monitoring utility that came with your motherboard.



CPU-Z is an easy way to verify processor information

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Two odd problems

Q Hi, I have two queries . Every time I start my computer I get these errors.

1. Cannot find script file "C:\WINDOWS\system32\boot.vbs".
2. Windows cannot find 'wproxp.exe'. Make sure you typed the name correctly, and then try

VBS errors on startup are a common sign of a worm

